

CHAPTER 6.

An Act for establishing a Ministry of National Service, and for purposes incidental thereto. [28th March 1917.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

Appointment
of Minister of
National
Service.

1.—(1) For the purpose of making the best use of all persons, whether men or women, able to work in any industry, occupation, or service, it shall be lawful for His Majesty to appoint a Minister of National Service under the title of Director-General of National Service, who shall hold office during His Majesty's pleasure.

5 & 6 Geo. 5.
c. 8.

(2) The Director-General of National Service shall, for that purpose, have such powers and duties of any Government department or authority, whether conferred by statute or otherwise, as His Majesty may by Order in Council transfer to him or authorise him to exercise or perform concurrently with or in consultation with the Government department or authority concerned, and also such further powers as may be conferred on him by regulations under the Defence of the Realm Consolidation Act, 1914, and regulations may be made under that Act accordingly, but no Order in Council or regulation shall authorise the compulsory employment or transfer of any person in or to any industry, occupation, or service, or shall impose any penalty for any breach of a voluntary agreement made by any person with the Director-General of National Service.

Supplemental
provisions as
to Ministry of
National
Service.

2.—(1) The Minister of National Service may adopt an official seal, and describe himself generally by the style and title of the Director-General of National Service; and the seal of the Minister shall be officially and judicially noticed, and shall be authenticated by the signature of the Minister or of a secretary or some person authorised by the Minister to act in that behalf.

6 & 7 Geo. 5.
c. 68.

(2) Section ten, subsections (2) to (5) of section eleven, and sections twelve, thirteen, and fourteen of the New Ministries and Secretaries Act, 1916, shall apply to the Minister and Ministry of National Service and to the office of Director-General of National Service and to Orders in Council made for the purposes of this Act and powers and duties transferred by virtue of this Act, as they apply to the Minister and Ministry of Food and the office of Food Controller and to Orders in Council made for the purposes of that Act and powers and duties transferred by virtue of that Act.

(3) Notwithstanding anything in any Act, a member of the House of Commons shall not vacate his seat by reason only of

his acceptance at any time within one month after the commencement of this Act of the office of secretary in the Ministry of National Service.

3. This Act may be cited as the Ministry of National Service Act, 1917. Short title.

CHAPTER 7.

An Act to apply certain sums out of the Consolidated Fund to the service of the years ending on the thirty-first day of March one thousand nine hundred and seventeen and one thousand nine hundred and eighteen.

[28th March 1917.]

Most Gracious Sovereign,

WE, Your Majesty's most dutiful and loyal subjects, the Commons of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland in Parliament assembled, towards making good the supply which we have cheerfully granted to Your Majesty in this session of Parliament, have resolved to grant unto Your Majesty the sums herein-after mentioned; and do therefore most humbly beseech Your Majesty that it may be enacted, and be it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1. The Treasury may issue out of the Consolidated Fund of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland, and apply towards making good the supply granted to His Majesty for the service of the year ending on the thirty-first day of March one thousand nine hundred and seventeen, the sum of sixty million four hundred and twenty-three thousand five hundred and seventy-five pounds.

Issue of
60,423,575l.
out of the
Consolidated
Fund for the
service of the
year ending
31st March
1917.

2. The Treasury may issue out of the Consolidated Fund of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland, and apply towards making good the supply granted to His Majesty for the service of the year ending on the thirty-first day of March one thousand nine hundred and eighteen, the sum of thirty-eight million twenty-five thousand pounds.

Issue of
38,025,000l.
out of the
Consolidated
Fund for the
service of the
year ending
31st March
1918.

3.—(1) The Treasury may borrow from any person, by the issue of Treasury Bills or otherwise, and the Bank of England and the Bank of Ireland may advance to the Treasury on the credit of the said sums, any sum or sums not exceeding in the whole ninety-eight million four hundred and forty-eight thousand five hundred and seventy-five pounds.

Power for the
Treasury to
borrow.